

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

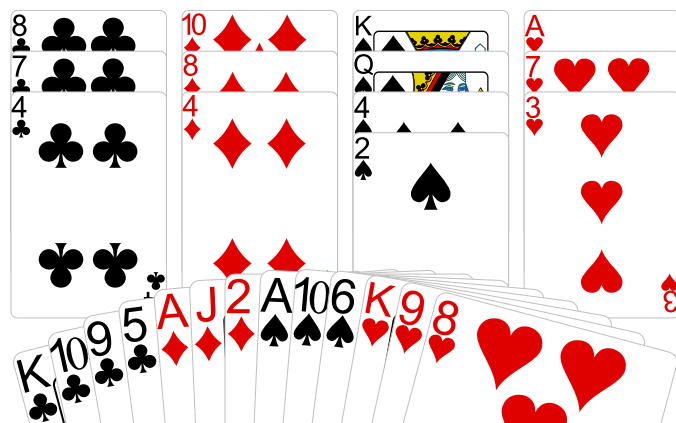
- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



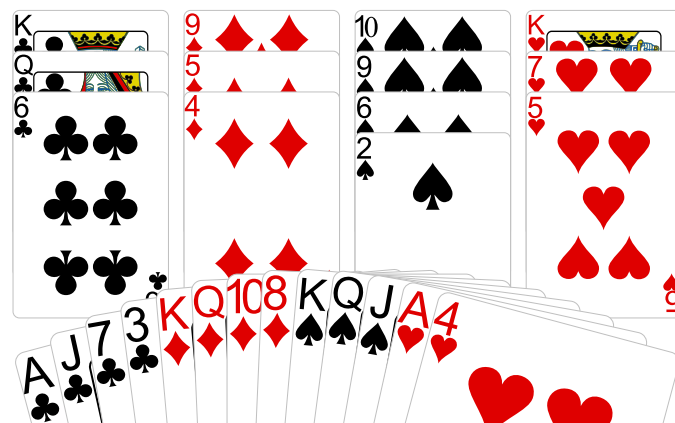
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4NT
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East

Deal 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ K 9 7 6 5
♣ Q J 6 3

15
6 10
9

♠ A T 6
♥ K 9 8
♦ A J 2
♣ K T 9 5



♠ K Q 4 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ T 8 4
♣ 8 7 4

♠ J 9 8 7 5
♥ Q J T 4
♦ Q 3
♣ A 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
2NT by North			

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This time NORTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between

24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

NORTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 4 2
♣ 9 8 7 3

7
2 20
11

♠ T 9 5 3
♥ Q 9 4 2
♦ K 9 8 7
♣ Q



♠ A 8
♥ K 7 6
♦ T 6 5 3
♣ A T 6 4

♠ K Q 6
♥ A J T 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2

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EAST has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution.

It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

WEST adds her 2 points to EAST's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the

magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

West	North	East	South
		2NT	

All Pass

2NT by East

Deal 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6 5 4
 ♥ J 4 3
 ♦ A 7 6
 ♣ 5 2

9
 7 8
 16

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ Q 7 2
 ♦ J 9 4
 ♣ Q J T 8



♠ A T 8
 ♥ A T 9
 ♦ K Q T 8
 ♣ K 9 7

♠ J 2
 ♥ K 8 6 5
 ♦ 5 3 2
 ♣ A 6 4 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	1NT
All Pass		Pass	3NT
3NT by South			

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SOUTH has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

NORTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking SOUTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But SOUTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice.

In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points.

Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good"

and bids 3NT.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J
♥ A 4
♦ K Q T 8
♣ A J 7 3

7
20 8
5

♠ 5
♥ Q J 8 6 3 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ T 9 8



♠ A 8 7 4 3
♥ T 9
♦ J 6 2
♣ 5 4 2

♠ T 9 6 2
♥ K 7 5
♦ 9 5 4
♣ K Q 6

West

2NT

All Pass

3NT by West

North

Pass

East

3NT

South

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WEST has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution,
so he opens 2NT.

EAST has 8 points. She adds WEST's 20 or 21
for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but

nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she
bids 3NT and WEST passes.

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Deal 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 5
♥ A 8 4
♦ 8 7 4
♣ T 9 6 5

15
5 4
16

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q 9 5
♦ K Q 6 2
♣ K 8 3



♠ A T 8
♥ K J 3
♦ A J 5
♣ Q J 7 2

♠ 7 6 3 2
♥ T 7 6 2
♦ T 9 3
♣ A 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	4NT
Pass			
4NT by North			

Deal 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 8 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ K J 3
♣ K T 5 2

6
9 15
10

♠ J 9 7 3
♥ A J T 4
♦ 8 5
♣ 8 6 4



♠ K 6 2
♥ 9 3 2
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ Q J 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K 8 5
♦ Q T 7 6
♣ A 9 7

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EAST has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

WEST has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid.

So she says 2NT.

Since EAST is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	
2NT			Pass
All Pass			
2NT by East			